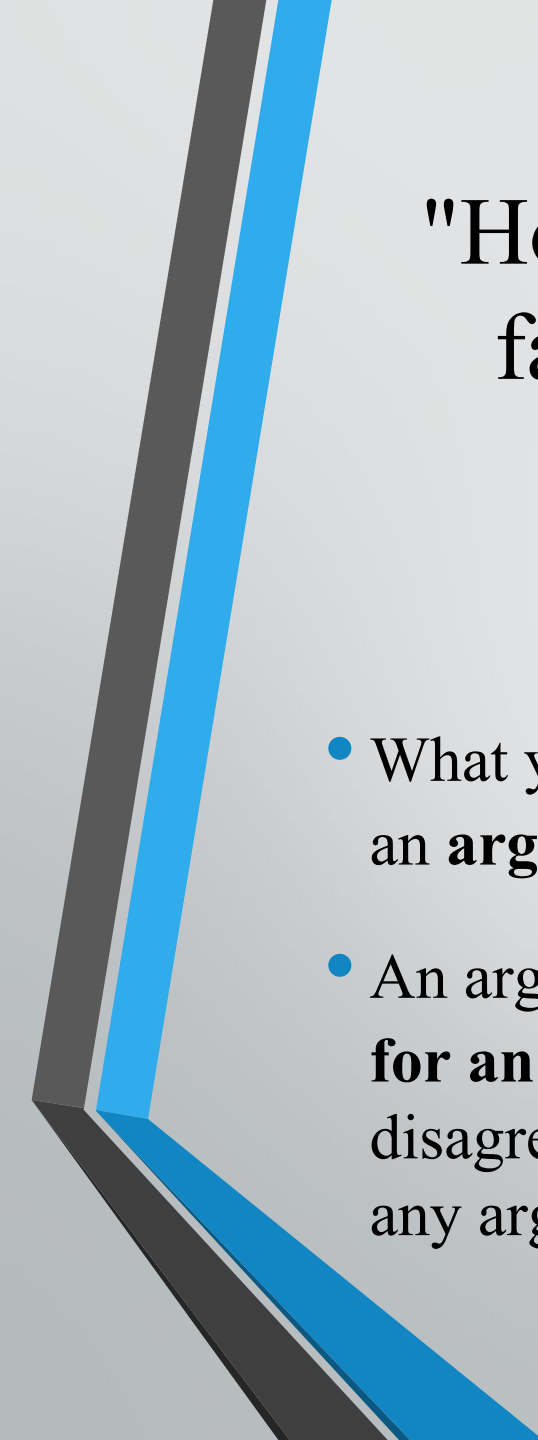




Argumentative Essay

To be or not to be



"How many of you have presented an idea to your family or friends, and they said: *'I don't like it. Make the logo bigger. Add more colours.'* ?

- What you needed in that moment wasn't better Photoshop skills. You needed an **argument**.
- An argumentative essay is not a boring school exercise. It is a **design rationale for an idea**. You are defending your 'concept' against someone who initially disagrees. Today, in 50 minutes, you will learn the simple architecture of winning any argument on paper."

The 5-Paragraph Skeleton

Paragraph	Role in Design Terms	Sentence-by-Sentence Template
1. Introduction	The Creative Brief	Hook → Context → Problem → Thesis (your main claim)
2. Body 1	Research & Evidence	Topic sentence → Evidence (fact/example) → Explain → Link back to thesis
3. Body 2	Rationale (Why it works)	Topic sentence → Evidence → Explain → Link
4. Body 3	Counterargument (Addressing client doubts)	"Some might say..." → But/However → Your rebuttal → Stronger evidence
5. Conclusion	Call to Action	Restate thesis (new words) → Summarize main points → Final powerful statement

Key takeaway for students:

- *"If you remember nothing else, remember this: State your claim, prove it three times, answer the sceptic, and end strong."*

Ethos, Pathos, Logos (The Secret Weapon)

- "Aristotle figured this out 2,000 years ago. Every persuasive argument uses three 'appeals.' And you already use them in design."

Minutes: Ethos, Pathos, Logos (The Secret Weapon)

Appeal	Meaning	In an Essay	In Design (Example)
Ethos	Credibility / Trust	Citing experts; using professional tone; showing you know the topic	Using a clean, trustworthy layout for a bank website
Pathos	Emotion / Feeling	Using vivid language; telling a short story; connecting to reader's values	Using warm colors and smiling faces for a charity poster
Logos	Logic / Reason	Using data, statistics, facts, and clear reasoning	Showing a clear information hierarchy in an infographic

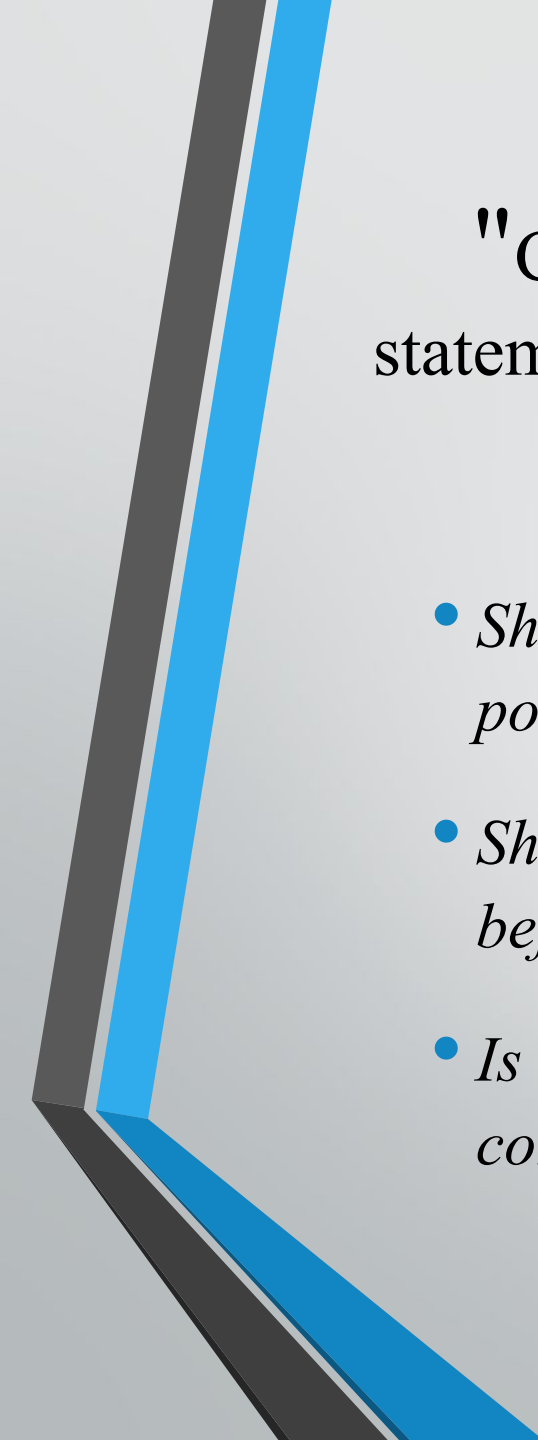
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- "Look at this sentence: '*Universities should ban laptops in classrooms because studies show students who take handwritten notes retain 30% more information.*' Which appeal is that?"

Should social media platforms be held legally responsible for the mental health impact of their design features (e.g., infinite scroll, like buttons)?

- "Yes" or "No"
- Give one reason. "Because they design features intentionally."
- Give a second reason. "Because they profit from user attention."
- *"Social media platforms should be held legally responsible for the mental health impact of their design features because they intentionally engineer addictive mechanisms, profit from prolonged user engagement, and have the data to foresee the harm."*

A quick outline

- **Body 1:** Evidence of intentional design (infinite scroll, notifications)
- **Body 2:** Evidence of profit motive (ad revenue tied to time spent)
- **Body 3:** Counterargument: "But users choose to be on these apps." Rebuttal: "Design exploits psychological vulnerabilities, making it not a free choice."

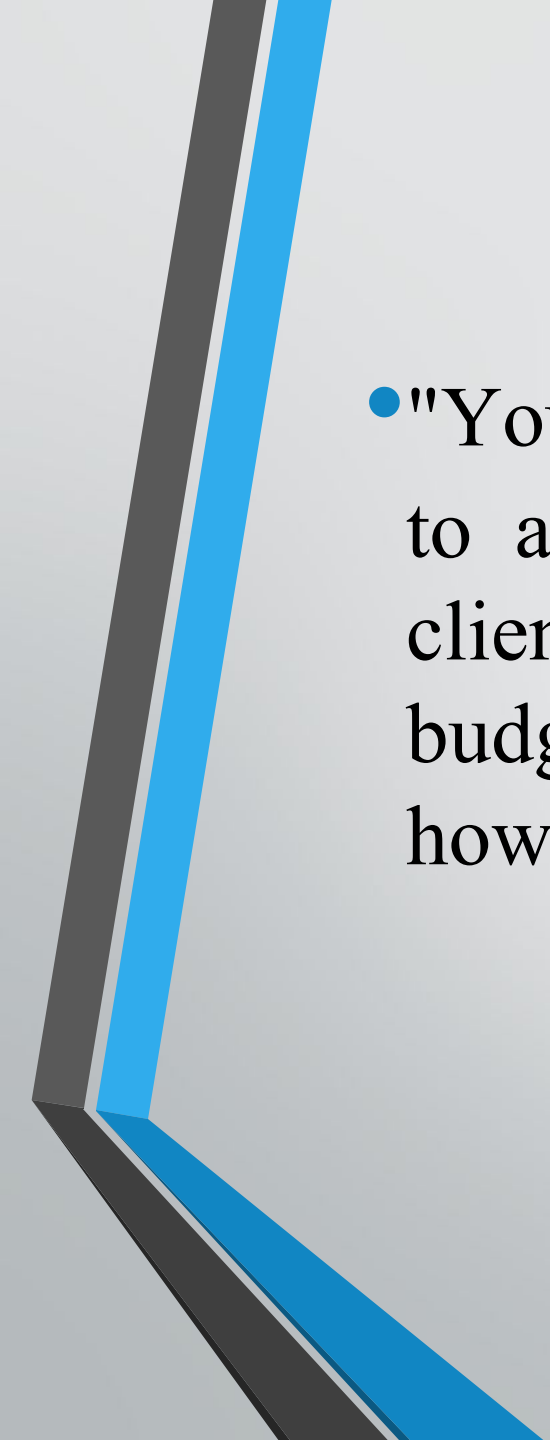


"Choose one prompt. In 5 minutes, write a single, clear thesis statement (1-2 sentences) taking a side and giving two reasons. Then write one topic sentence for your first body paragraph."

- *Should AI-generated art be considered "original" work in design portfolios?*
- *Should design programs require all students to learn hand-drawing before digital tools?*
- *Is it ethical for designers to use "dark patterns" (trick UI) to increase conversions for clients?*

Wrap-Up & Checklist

#	Check for...	Ask Yourself...
1	A clear thesis	Does my first paragraph end with one sentence that takes a side?
2	Three body paragraphs	Does each start with a topic sentence that supports my thesis?
3	Evidence	Did I include a fact, example, or quote in each body paragraph?
4	Counterargument	Did I spend at least 2-3 sentences addressing the other side?
5	Strong conclusion	Did I avoid just repeating myself? Did I end with a punch?

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- "Your design portfolio gets you in the door. Your ability to argue for your work keeps you in the room. Every client pitch, every proposal, every email asking for a budget increase is an argumentative essay. Now you know how to write it."

- ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY = DESIGN RATIONALE FOR AN IDEA

- STRUCTURE:

- 1. Intro → Thesis (Your claim)
- 2. Body 1 → Evidence
- 3. Body 2 → More evidence
- 4. Body 3 → Counterargument + Rebuttal
- 5. Conclusion → Restate + Call to action

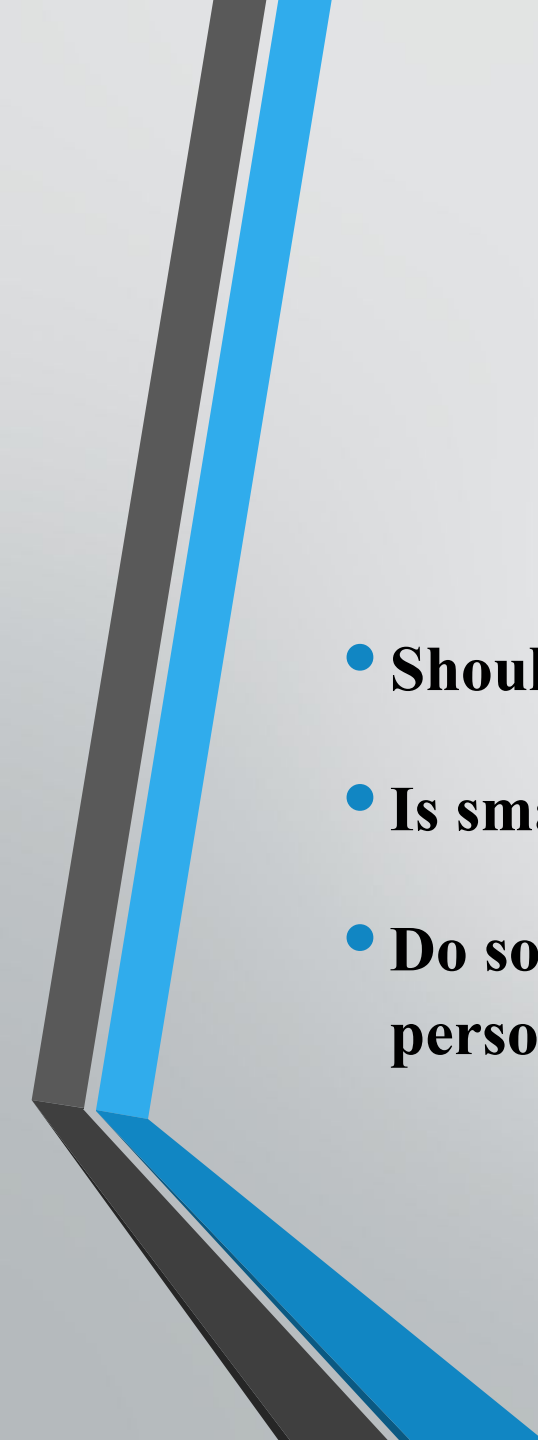
- THE 3 APPEALS:

- - Ethos = Credibility (Trust me)
- - Pathos = Emotion (Feel this)
- - Logos = Logic (See the reason)

- THESIS FORMULA:

[Side] + because [Reason 1] + and [Reason 2]

Example: "Social media should be regulated because it harms mental health and spreads misinformation."

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- **Should Canva be considered a legitimate professional design tool?**
 - **Is smartphone photography "real photography"?**
 - **Do social media portfolios (Instagram, Behance) replace the need for personal websites?**

Part A: Edit the following passage by inserting appropriate punctuation marks and capitalization where necessary.

"The students are going to the library. They will study for their exams. It's a quiet place where they can focus on their books.

Don't you think it's a great idea?" said the teacher.

"Oh, yes," replied the students. "We will learn a lot there. Let's go now."

the students are going to the library they will study for their exams its a quiet place where they can focus on their books dont you think its a great idea said the teacher oh yes replied the students we will learn a lot there lets go now

- Higher education plays a vital role in personal and professional development.
(1)___ Firstly ___, it equips individuals with specialized knowledge and critical thinking skills. (2)___ However ___, many students struggle to balance academic responsibilities with personal commitments.
(3)___ Fortunately/Therefore ___, effective time management can help them overcome these challenges. (4)
___ Moreover/Additionally/Furthermore ___, universities should provide counseling and academic support services. (5)
___ However/Nevertheless ___, students must take responsibility for their own learning.